

cation. However, this assumption is simply not true. While most Chinese in ancient times were no more interested in the languages of surrounding people than they are interested in minority languages of China today, those who were interested left us samples of very careful and reliable transcriptions that can and must be utilised with application of proper knowledge of Chinese historical phonology. In addition, Bazin, in all probability, did not read attentively the preceding passage. The translation of Xiong-nu poem is done by Futo Cheng himself. And we do know that Futo Cheng, an Indian monk, was multilingual. He was of course, fluent in Chinese, and we can expect that being a close confidant of Shi Le, he was quite familiar with the Xiong-nu language as well. Thus, the possibility of incorrect segmentation is almost non-existent. Bazin, however, does his own segmentation, which is solely justified by his Turkic interpretation.

First, Bazin believes that the word for army is just 秀, and not 秀支 as Futo Cheng says. He further analyses this 秀 as representing Old Turkic *sü-g* "army-acc." Therefore, Bazin, like Ramstedt, tries to connect the first word with Old Turkic *sü* in spite of the difference in vocalism that I already mentioned above. In addition, his accusative case marker *-g* is based on Karlgren's reconstruction **siôg* as a reading of this character in Archaic Chinese, but nowadays we now that **-g* simply was not there, but possibly final **-s* was (Baxter 1991: 798). Bazin is more careful than Ramstedt with the vocalism of the title "bok-kok, but his proposal seems no less strange. He suggests that the word must be Old Turkic *buquγ* or *boquγ*, that is not attested per se, but reconstructed by Bazin on the basis of Old Turkic *buqay* found preceding Old Turkic *tutuq* "gouverneur militaire", and Old Osman *boγ* "chef militaire, commandant d'une troupe", that, as he believes, is a contraction from *boquγ* (Bazin 1948: 211). There is, however, one difficulty on the Turkic side: although Old Turkic is known for using constructions consisting of synonym pairs, like *ï ÿaç* "plants" (lit. plant+tree), it is by no means known that Old Turkic *buqay* in *buqay tutuq* is a title. "Old Turkic dictionary" glosses it as a personal name (Nadeliav et al 1969: 125).⁸ Even if Bazin is right in this particular case, the title is useless for deter-

8 No entry in Clauson 1972.